

July

31

Oldest working zoo

Holy Roman Emperor Franz I founded the Vienna Zoo in the grounds of Austria's famous Schönbrunn Palace. It was opened to the public in 1778.

1752



Born this day

1973 Andy Macdonald, US skateboarder. He has won the World Cup Skateboarding Series nine times.



Daredevil flight

2003

Austrian skydiver Felix Baumgartner became the first person to fly across the English Channel using a carbon wing. He jumped from a plane above Dover, UK, and soared 35 km (22 miles), before landing safely near Calais, France.

Also on this day

1581 Johann von Schöenberg became the Archbishop of Trier, Germany. He went on to lead one of Europe's biggest witch trials.

1658 Aurangzeb took the throne as the sixth Mughal emperor. During his reign, the Mughal Empire reached its largest size.

2013 The US White House honoured Black American Kimberly Bryant as a "Champion of Change". She founded Black Girls Code, an organization that teaches computer skills to young girls.

First Moon drive

1971

US astronauts David Scott and James Irwin from NASA's *Apollo 15* mission became the first people to drive a vehicle on the Moon when they set off to explore in the four-wheel, electric Lunar Roving Vehicle (LRV).

